Linkast — UI inventory

Every screen, section, tab and control in the Linkast desktop app, with a one-line note on what it does. Written as a starting point for a UI/UX refactor.

App version 0.5.0-beta.6 · Windows desktop app (WPF, Windows 11 look) · Prepared 28 October 2026 from the app's source

What Linkast is. A lightweight, local-only live-streaming app for Windows (an OBS alternative for gamers). It captures a game, window or display, adds webcams with effects and overlays (alerts, logos), mixes sound, and streams to Twitch, YouTube, Kick, Facebook or any RTMP server. You can pick which network the stream uses (for example Wi-Fi vs. a phone hotspot). No account, no cloud, no telemetry.

Key ideas behind the UI

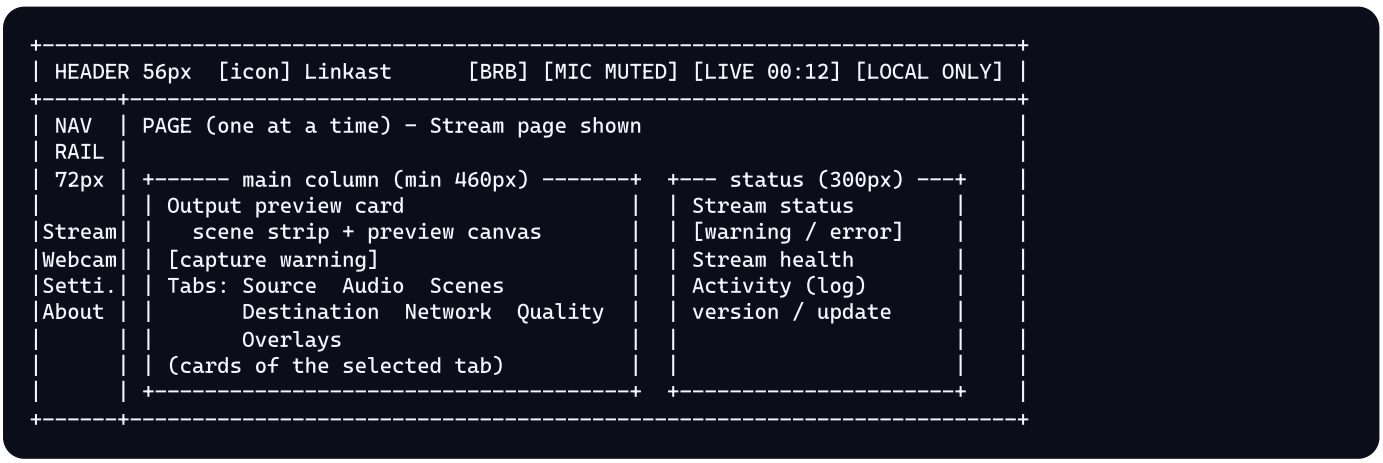
- **Sources are set up once, scenes decide what shows.** A scene says which game, cameras, overlays, background and sounds appear. Switching scenes while live is instant.
- **Live vs. not live.** Some settings are locked while streaming (LOCKED LIVE); others work instantly while live (WORKS LIVE). The UI should make this obvious.
- **The Linkast window is often on stream itself**, so secrets (stream key, alert links) are masked or hidden after entry.
- Dark and light themes plus "Match Windows". Every colour comes from design tokens (section 3).

Contents

1. Window structure
2. Logo and brand assets
3. Design tokens (colours, type, spacing, radii, motion)
4. Component library
5. Header bar
6. Navigation rail
7. Stream page: left column (preview, scenes, 7 tabs)
8. Stream page: right status column
9. Webcam Studio page (3 tabs)
10. Settings page
11. About page
12. Dialogs, menus and system pickers
13. Stream states
14. Keyboard shortcuts
15. Icons in use
16. Notes for the redesign

1. Window structure

One main window, default 1280 × 820, minimum 960 × 620, centred on screen. No secondary windows except standard Windows message boxes and file pickers.



Pages scroll vertically; nothing scrolls horizontally except the audio mixer strip. Webcam Studio and Settings are capped at 1100 px wide, About at 860 px.

2. Logo and brand assets

The mark: an "L" whose stem is shared with a "k" (arm and leg), filled with one continuous gradient cyan → blue → violet. The **app icon** places the mark on a deep-navy rounded square. The vector source of truth is `src/Linkast.App/Themes/Brand.xaml`; a script renders the .ico and PNGs from it.



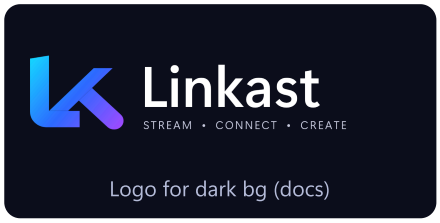
App icon (header, 32 px, rounded clip)



Logo (About page, 96 px)



Mark only



Logo for dark bg (docs)



Logo for light bg (docs)

Asset	Where it is used
linkast.ico	Window/taskbar icon, installer
linkast-256.png	Header, top-left, 32 × 32 with 7 px rounded corners
linkast-logo.png	About page, 96 × 96
linkast-1024.png, linkast-transparent.png, linkast-logo-without-text.png	Store/README/marketing sizes; not shown in the app UI
docs/assets/linkast-logo-dark/light.png, linkast-mark.png	README and documentation
"Linkast Camera" placeholder.png	Picture the virtual camera shows to other apps when nothing is ready

Wordmark in the header: "Linkast" (Display font, 17 px bold) with the tagline **STREAM · CONNECT · CREATE** (9.5 px, tertiary text).

3. Design tokens

All colours are tokens with a dark and a light value (`Themes/Tokens.Dark.xaml`, `Tokens.Light.xaml`). Soft variants are the same colour at about 12–16 % opacity, used for tinted backgrounds.

Brand (same in both themes)

BrandCyan #18D2FF | BrandBlue #2F6BFF | BrandViolet #A24CFF | Navy #1D1B48 → #090A1C

Gradients: **GoLiveGradient** (cyan → blue → violet, used only on the Go live button), **NavMarkerGradient** (the 3 px bar beside the selected nav item).

Theme colours

Token	Dark	Light	Used for
AppBg	`#0B0D1B`	`#F4F6FC`	Window background
Surface1	`#11142A`	`#FFFFFF`	Header, nav rail, cards
Surface2	`#171B35`	`#F8F9FF`	Panels inside cards, scene tiles, mixer channels, overlay cards
Surface3	`#202646`	`#EEF1FF`	Selected nav item, thumbnails, badges
SurfaceHover	`#252B4B`	`#E8EDFF`	Hover
BorderSubtle / BorderStrong	`#2A3154` / `#3B4771`	`#DCE2F3` / `#BBC7E8`	Card borders / hover, preview frame
TextPrimary / Secondary / Tertiary	`#F4F6FF` / `#B5BCD9` / `#8993B8`	`#151936` / `#414B70` / `#626D91`	Text hierarchy
Accent (+Hover, Pressed, Soft)	`#6B8EFF`	`#2858D8`	Primary buttons, selection, checked toggles
OnAccent	`#0B0D1B`	`#FFFFFF`	Text on accent
Focus	`#18D2FF`	`#087EAA`	Keyboard focus ring, selected colour swatch
Live	`#FF5964`	`#C62838`	LIVE pill, End stream, ON AIR, delete actions, camera-active dot
Warning	`#FFC15A`	`#805000`	Connecting/reconnecting, notes, BRB pill
Success	`#48D597`	`#087548`	Audio meters, CAMERA ACTIVE, test OK
Error	`#FF765E`	`#B9381B`	Error banner, MIC MUTED pill, record dot
Idle	`#9299B3`	`#626A83`	OFFLINE pill

Hard-coded colours outside the tokens: preview canvas background #05060E, camera-preview placeholder #07080F with text #8993B8 / #B5BCD9, the theme thumbnails in Settings, and "ON AIR" white text.

Typography

Role	Font	Size
Body	Segoe UI Variable Text	13 (labels 12, captions 11)
Card title	Body font, SemiBold	14
Page title	Segoe UI Variable Display	22

Status title ("Ready to stream")	Display	18
Go live / End stream label	Display, Bold	19
Timer	Tabular numerals	20
Metric value	—	18
About "Linkast"	Display, Bold	26
Code / server URL / log / diagnostics	Cascadia Mono, Consolas	11
Icons	Segoe Fluent Icons (MDL2 fallback)	16 (nav 20)

Spacing, radii, motion

Spacing scale	4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32. Page padding 22/18/22/22, card padding 16×14, control padding 12×7, gap between stacked cards 12.
Corner radii	Small 6 · Control 8 · Tile 9 · Action (buttons) 10 · Card 12 · Preview 14 · Pill 999
Control height	Text inputs min 34 px; Go live / End stream 48 px; nav items 56 px
Motion	Hover 100 ms · Press 80 ms · Panel 180 ms · State change 220 ms

4. Component library

Named styles in `Themes/Styles.xaml`. A redesign can restyle these in one place.

Component	Type	Look and logic
Button · Primary	Button	Accent fill. Main action of a card (Test connection, Find the best settings, Add picture, Update now).
Button · Secondary	Button	Neutral outlined. Ordinary actions.
Button · Subtle	Button	Transparent, secondary text. Low-priority actions in card headers (Refresh, Edit layout).
Button · Icon	Button	32 × 32 glyph-only, always with a tooltip (refresh cameras, remove overlay, clear hotkey).
Button · GoLive	Button	The only brand-gradient button. Full width, 48 px, 19 px bold white text.
Button · Destructive	Button	Solid red. End stream only.
Button · DestructiveOutline	Button	Red outline. Remove camera, Delete preset, Remove Linkast Camera.
ToggleButton · Secondary	Toggle	When on: accent-tinted background and border (Mute, Be right back, Show key).
ToggleButton · Subtle	Toggle	Transparent toggle (Show log).
Nav item	Radio button	Icon above label, 56 px. Selected: Surface3 background and a gradient bar on the left.
Segmented	List (single select)	A row of joined options. Used both as **tabs** (Stream tabs, Studio tabs, Inspector tabs) and as **value pickers** (platform, shape, background mode).
Choice	List (single select)	Larger selectable cards (network list, theme thumbnails, camera picker).
Card	Container	Surface1, 1 px subtle border, radius 12. Every section is a card.
Card · Feature	Container	Card with accent border. Used once: Network card.
Issue · Warning / Error	Banner	Tinted banner with icon (capture may be black, stream warnings, last error).
Status pill (Idle/Live/Warning/Error/Success/Brand)	Badge	Rounded label, uppercase: OFFLINE, ● LIVE, CONNECTING, ERROR, LOCAL ONLY, GPL-3.0-or-later…
Metric tile	Container	Label, large value, small caption (Stream health numbers).
Value slider	Custom	Label + slider + current value with unit (e.g. "1.50×", "40%"). If a default exists, a small reset button appears.
Colour swatches	List	Row of 26 px round chips; the selected one gets a focus-coloured ring.
Expander	Disclosure	Hides advanced options (Advanced capture, Advanced encoding, Manage presets, Technical details…).
Field label / Hint / Body text	Text	Label above inputs; Hint = small secondary helper text (used a lot, often long).
Focus visual	—	Keyboard focus ring in the Focus colour on every control.

Standard controls	—	Combo box (dropdown), text box, password box, check box, slider, progress bar, context menu, scroll bars: themed Windows 11 (Fluent) controls.

5. Header bar (always visible)

Element	Type	Logic
App icon + "Linkast" + tagline	Logo, text	Static branding, left.
BE RIGHT BACK	Pill (warning)	Shown only while the Be right back scene is on.
MIC MUTED	Pill (error)	Shown only while the microphone is muted in the stream.
Stream state + elapsed time	Pill + timer	Shown only while streaming/recording; same pill as the status card, so state is visible on every page.
LOCAL ONLY	Pill (neutral)	Always shown. Tooltip: "No account, no cloud, no telemetry".

6. Navigation rail (left, 72 px)

Item	Type	Logic
Stream (Alt+S)	Nav radio	Default page. Preview, scenes, all stream settings, go live.
Webcam (Alt+W)	Nav radio	Webcam Studio: cameras, effects, layout, virtual camera.
Settings (Alt+T)	Nav radio	Appearance, updates, hotkeys, OBS import, diagnostics.
About (Alt+B)	Nav radio	Version, licence, open-source notices.

7. Stream page — main column

Page title "Stream", subtitle "Preview your output, choose your network, then go live."

7.1 Output preview card

Element	Type	Logic
"Output preview" title + resolution pill	Text, pill	Pill shows the canvas, e.g. "1920×1080".
Edit layout	Subtle button	Jumps to Webcam Studio → Layout.
Scene strip	Tile list (wrap)	One 112 × 64 tile per scene: icon, name, number badge (1–9 = hotkey). Click = switch scene (instant while live). Active scene: accent border and soft-accent fill. While live, active tile turns red with an **ON AIR** badge.
Scene tile right-click menu	Context menu	Duplicate · Move earlier · Move later · Delete. Right-click does not switch scene (that would go on air).
+ (Add scene)	Icon button → menu	Menu of templates: Gaming: game with camera · Just chatting: large camera · Starting soon · Be right back · Ending: thanks for watching · Empty scene. Disabled at the scene limit.
Preview canvas (scene editor)	Interactive canvas	Shows exactly what viewers see, max 340 px tall. Drag an overlay, camera or the game picture to move; drag a corner to resize (keeps shape); drag an edge to resize one side; **Alt** + drag an edge to trim (crop). Only the hovered/selected item shows outline and handles; the selected item is tinted and labelled with name and size. While the Overlays tab is open every overlay shows its outline and name. The game snapshot refreshes every 2 s. Items with no picture (camera off, page loading, missing file) show as a named box.
Hint under preview	Hint text	Explains drag / resize / Alt-trim.

7.2 Capture warning banner (conditional)

"The game may capture as black"	Warning banner	Shown when the chosen game is likely to capture black (fullscreen exclusive etc.). Text explains why.
Capture this display instead…	Secondary button	Switches to full-display capture after a confirmation dialog (privacy warning). Works while live.

7.3 Stream settings tabs

A segmented control with 7 tabs: **Source · Audio · Scenes · Destination · Network · Quality · Overlays**. One tab's cards are shown at a time.

Tab: Source — card "Capture for <scene name>"

Element	Type	Logic
Refresh	Subtle button	Reloads displays, windows and audio devices.
Video source	Dropdown	Entire display · Single window or game · No game (cameras and overlays only) · Test pattern. Per scene. WORKS LIVE (short pause).
Display	Dropdown	Shown when source = display. Pick monitor.

Window	Dropdown	Shown when source = window. Pick game/window.
Scene capture note	Warning text	Conditional, e.g. the window is gone.
Display privacy hint	Hint	"Everything on this display is captured..." (display only).
Advanced capture	Expander	☐ Use Desktop Duplication instead of Windows Graphics Capture (displays only) · ☐ Capture the mouse cursor.

Tab: Audio — card "Audio"

Element	Type	Logic
System audio (what you hear)	Checkbox + dropdown	On/off and output device to capture. LOCKED LIVE
Microphone	Checkbox + dropdown	On/off and input device. LOCKED LIVE
Mute / Muted	Toggle button	Mutes the mic in the stream. WORKS LIVE Same toggle exists in the status card.
Remove background noise (fans, hum)	Checkbox	Noise suppression on the mic. WORKS LIVE
Game sound on its own fader	Checkbox	Captured window's app gets its own fader (its sound is also in desktop audio).
"Mixer · <scene>" label	Text	The mixer always shows the active scene.
Mixer channel (repeated, horizontal scroll)	Channel strip	One per sound (desktop, mic, game, each alert overlay, background video). Contains: icon + name; vertical **level meter** (green); vertical **volume fader** 0–200 % (100 % = unchanged); value text (% and dB); 3 small buttons: **Mute** (all scenes), **Silent in this scene**, **Reset to 100 %**; optional **Test sound** button (alerts only — plays a chime; viewers hear it if live) and its result text; "Silent in this scene" warning; optional note. WORKS LIVE
Empty state	Text	"Turn on Desktop audio or the microphone to hear them in your stream."

Tab: Scenes — card "This scene"

Element	Type	Logic
← / → (move earlier/later)	Icon buttons	Reorder the active scene in the strip.
Duplicate · Delete	Subtle buttons	Copy / delete the active scene (Delete in red; disabled for the last scene).
Name	Text input	Scene name, max 40 chars.
Show the game or screen	Checkbox	Hide capture for chatting/starting/ending scenes (keeps running, so switching back is instant).
Background	Segmented	None · Linkast card · Picture · Video (loops).
Title / Message	Text inputs	Only for "Linkast card": text drawn on the card (60 / 100 chars).
File name + Change...	Text + subtle button	Only for Picture/Video: shows file, opens file picker.
Silent in this scene	Checkbox list	One checkbox per mixer sound (same as the mixer's middle button).
Overlays in this scene	Checkbox list	One checkbox per overlay: shown in this scene or not.

Card "Going live and ending"

Go live starts on	Dropdown	Scene to start every stream on (e.g. Starting soon).

End stream first shows	Dropdown	Scene shown before ending (e.g. Ending).
For (seconds)	Number input	3–120 s; then the stream ends by itself.
Hotkeys hint	Hint	Lists Ctrl+Alt+1–9, Ctrl+Alt+←/→, Ctrl+Alt+B.

Tab: Destination — card "Where to stream" LOCKED LIVE

Element	Type	Logic
"Key is masked and never logged"	Icon + hint	Reassurance, header right.
Platform	Segmented	Twitch · YouTube · Kick · Facebook · Custom.
Server: <url>	Read-only text	Preset platforms: server filled in automatically.
Where do I find my key?	Subtle link button	Opens the platform's stream-key page in the browser.
Delivery type (Custom only)	Segmented	Direct to a platform · Through a restream service; explanation text below.
Server URL (Custom only)	Text input	rtmp:// or rtmps:// address, with example hint.
Stream key	Password input	Masked. Saved encrypted for the Windows account. Clear to forget.
Show / Hide	Toggle button	Reveals the key as plain text.

Tab: Network — card "Network for your stream" (feature card) LOCKED LIVE

Element	Type	Logic
Refresh	Subtle button	Looks for network adapters again.
Explanation hint	Hint	Only Linkast's stream uses the chosen network; Windows settings never change.
Network list	Choice list	One card per option: icon in a 34 px square (Wi-Fi, mobile, USB tethering, VPN, Ethernet), name, details. Includes an automatic/default option.
Test connection	Primary button	Connects to the server via the chosen network (no video sent) and shows which network really was used.
Test result	Status text	Green when OK, red when failed.

Tab: Quality — card "Quality" LOCKED LIVE

Element	Type	Logic
"Not sure what to pick?" panel	Inset panel	Auto setup.
Find the best settings	Primary button	Tests encoders and upload (~30 s), then suggests resolution, frame rate, bitrate.
Your upload speed (Mbps) + Measure it in your browser	Input + link button	Only for platforms where upload can't be measured automatically (not Twitch). Link opens speed.cloudflare.com.
Progress / status text	Text	Auto setup progress.
Suggested … + Apply	Text + primary button	Shows recommendation; Apply fills the fields.
Encoder · Resolution · Frame rate	Dropdowns	Hardware encoder (NVENC, etc.) or x264; output size; FPS.
Bitrate (kbps)	Number input	Video bitrate; hints about Twitch's 6000 limit and upload ×1.5 rule.

Also record when I go live	Checkbox	Saves every stream to a file too.
Recordings folder + Change… + Open	Read-only input + buttons	Where recordings go; folder picker; open in Explorer.
Make an MP4 copy when a recording ends	Checkbox	Recordings are MKV (crash-safe); this adds an MP4 copy.
Advanced encoding	Expander	Keyframe interval (s) · Audio bitrate (kbps) · Encoder preset (text).

Tab: Overlays — card "Overlays in <scene name>" WORKS LIVE

Element	Type	Logic
Add picture	Primary button	File picker; adds a logo/picture to the active scene (max 8 overlays in total).
Add alerts or web page	Primary button	Adds a web overlay (alert box link from Streamlabs, StreamElements, Reymit…).
From another scene + Add to this scene	Dropdown + button	Reuse an overlay from another scene, with that scene's position/size/trim.
Empty state	Inset text	"This scene has no overlays yet…"
Overlay card (repeated)	Selectable card	Click anywhere = select it in the preview (card gets accent border). Contains:
· **Thumbnail**	Image 96×54	Picture preview, or "Missing file" in warning colour.
· **Name**	Text input	Editable, 40 chars.
· **Change picture**	Subtle button	Pictures only.
· **Show in preview**	Icon button (pin)	Flashes the overlay in the preview.
· **Remove**	Icon button (red)	Removes from this scene (deleted when no scene has it).
· **Link (web, first time)**	Text input + Save link	Enter https:// link once.
· **"Link saved and hidden" + Change link + Reload**	Status + subtle buttons	After saving, the link is hidden because it contains an account token and the window may be on stream. Reload re-fetches the page.
· **Problem**	Warning text	e.g. page failed to load.
· **Position**	Dropdown	Full screen · Top left/center/right · Middle left · Center · Middle right · Bottom left/center/right · Custom (dragged in the preview).
· **Size**	Value slider	5–100 % of stream width.
· **Page width / Page height**	Number inputs	Web only, 100–3840 (like OBS browser source). LOCKED LIVE
· **"On stream: …"**	Hint	Final position and size in pixels.

8. Stream page — right status column (300 px)

Card "Stream status"

Element	Type	Logic
State pill	Pill	OFFLINE / PREPARING / CONNECTING / ● LIVE / RECONNECTING / STOPPING / ERROR (see section 13).
Status title	Large text	"Ready to stream", "Not ready yet", "Streaming normally", "Reconnecting…"…
Elapsed time	Timer	Running time.
Go live	GoLive button	Starts streaming (Ctrl+Enter). Visible only when not live. Same slot as End stream.
End stream	Destructive button	Visible only while live. If an end scene is set, it shows that first with a countdown ("The stream ends in N s. Press End stream again to end now.").
Record / Stop recording	Secondary button	Record to file without going live (red dot icon). Hidden while live.
Readiness text	Hint	"Checking FFmpeg and encoders…", "Ready", or the problem.
Last recording	Hint	Where the last recording was saved.
Mute / Muted	Toggle button	Quick mic mute. WORKS LIVE
Be right back	Toggle button	Switches to the BRB scene and back to where you were. WORKS LIVE

Banners (conditional)

Warning banner	Warning	Non-fatal stream warnings.
Error banner	Error	Category title (Capture / Audio / Encoding / Network / Settings / FFmpeg problem), message, **Test connection** button (network errors only), **Technical details** expander with copyable text.

Card "Stream health" — "Measured on the real connection"

Before live	Summary rows	"Live numbers appear here when you go live." Output (e.g. 1080p · 60 FPS · 6000 kbps), Encoder, Network.
While live	6 metric tiles (2×3)	Frame rate (encoded / target) · Upload (measured on socket) · Encoder speed (1× = real time) · Dropped / dup. frames · Reconnects (this stream) · Network used (verified on socket).

Card "Activity"

Show log / Hide log	Subtle toggle	Expands the log list (chevron flips).
Activity log	List (mono)	Timestamped events, max 260 px tall.
Copy report	Secondary button	Copies diagnostics to clipboard (never the stream key).
Open logs	Secondary button	Opens the log folder.

Footer

Version + update status	Subtle button	e.g. "0.5.0-beta.6 · Up to date"; update text turns accent + bold when a new version exists. Click → Settings.

9. Webcam Studio page

Title "Webcam Studio", subtitle "Shape your cameras, add effects and place them on your stream." Top segmented tabs with icons: **Camera & effects · Layout · Linkast Camera**.

Cameras bar (shown on Camera & effects and Layout)

Element	Type	Logic
Camera picker	Choice list (chips)	One chip per camera layer (up to 4). Red dot = camera running; "· hidden in this layout" when not shown in the current scene.
Add camera	Subtle button	Adds a camera layer.
Remove	Destructive outline	Removes the selected layer.
Notice	Warning text	e.g. limit reached.

9.1 Tab: Camera & effects

Two columns: camera card (left, flexible) and inspector (right, 360 px). Shows the selected camera only.

Camera card

Camera name	Card title	Layer name.
● CAMERA ACTIVE	Pill (success)	While the camera is running.
Camera on	Checkbox	Off releases the camera and hides it from the stream.
Device · Resolution	Dropdowns	Which camera, which format.
Refresh	Icon button	Look for cameras again.
Camera preview	Image (min 220 px)	Live picture with effects. Placeholder: camera icon + status; if none found, suggests phone apps (Iriun, DroidCam).
Diagnostics text	Hint	FPS / processing info.
Camera error	Warning banner	Conditional.

Inspector — segmented tabs: Look · Background · Framing · Effects

Element	Type	Logic
Look		
Preset + Reset	Dropdown + button	Built-ins: Gaming, Just Chatting, Professional, Low Light, Minimal (+ user presets). Shows "Custom look" when edited by hand. Reset = back to the preset.
Manage presets	Expander	Preset name input; Save as new · Update preset · Duplicate · Rename; Delete preset (red). Built-ins are locked.
Shape	Segmented	Rectangle · Rounded · Circle.
Aspect ratio	Dropdown	16:9 wide · 4:3 classic · 1:1 square · 9:16 portrait (disabled for circle).
Zoom · Corner radius · Border	Value sliders	1–4× · 0–50 % (rounded only) · 0–10 %.
Border colour	Swatches	Colour chips.
Mirror	Checkbox	Flip horizontally.

IMAGE: Brightness · Contrast · Saturation + Reset image	Value sliders	Picture adjustments.
Advanced image and camera settings	Expander	Sharpen · Noise reduction · Low-light boost · Crop left/right · Crop up/down; CAMERA HARDWARE: a slider + "Auto" checkbox per hardware control the camera supports (exposure, focus, white balance…).
Background		
Mode	Segmented	Original · Blur · Remove · Image.
Blur strength	Value slider	Blur only.
Background image + Choose image…	Text + button	Image mode only.
Edge softness	Value slider	Any effect.
PERFORMANCE: Quality	Dropdown	Performance (fastest) · Balanced (recommended) · Quality (sharpest edges).
Use the graphics card (recommended)	Checkbox	GPU vs CPU.
Status	Status text	Red if there's a problem.
Framing		
Keep my face in frame	Checkbox	Auto-framing on/off.
Face size · Headroom · Maximum zoom · Speed	Value sliders	Shown when on.
Status	Status text	Face found / problem.
Effects		
Border animation + Speed	Dropdown + slider	None · Pulse · Colour cycle.
Glow	Value slider	Soft glow in border colour.
React to my voice	Checkbox	Border/glow reacts to speech.
Style	Dropdown	Border grows with your voice · Glow ring lights up · Border changes colour while you speak.
Threshold (dB) · Intensity	Value sliders	Sensitivity and strength.
Speaking colour	Swatches	Only for the colour-change style.
Voice level + SPEAKING	Progress bar + pill	Live mic level; pill when speaking detected.

9.2 Tab: Layout

Element	Type	Logic
Layout (scene) picker	Segmented	The same scenes as the Stream page strip (short names). Each remembers its own positions; landscape or vertical (9:16 for Shorts/TikTok).
Gameplay: Fit · Fill	Segmented	Fit = whole picture, may show bars; Fill = no bars, edges cropped.
Snap	Checkbox	Snap to grid, edges, centre (guides shown).
Output pill	Pill	"Output 1920×1080".

Layout editor	Interactive canvas	Same editor as the preview but larger and with all handles: click to select, drag, corner-resize, Alt-trim, arrow keys nudge.
Layers card ("Last is drawn on top")	List	Rows per camera with running dot and "Shown" checkbox; selected row highlighted.
Bring forward · Send back	Secondary buttons	Change stacking order (applies at next go-live).
Selected camera card	Card	Name; "Show <name> in this layout" checkbox; position/size in pixels (mono).
QUICK PLACEMENT	6 tile buttons	Top left · Top right · Center · Bottom left · Bottom right · Full screen. Each tile draws a tiny frame with the position.

9.3 Tab: Linkast Camera (virtual camera)

Element	Type	Logic
"Linkast Camera for Zoom, Teams and Discord"	Card title	Use the Linkast look in video calls.
On	Checkbox	Sends the camera to apps using Linkast Camera (needs install).
Shows	Dropdown	Which camera layer is sent.
Status	Status text	Installed / in use / problem (red).
Set up Linkast Camera…	Primary button	Installs (one admin prompt). Shown when not installed.
Repair or update · Remove from this PC	Secondary · Destructive outline	Shown when installed.
"How to use it" panel	Inset panel	2 steps + "Needs Windows 11".

10. Settings page

Two columns of cards. Subtitle "Appearance, updates, hotkeys, importing from OBS and diagnostics."

Element	Type	Logic
Appearance		
Theme	Choice cards (3)	Dark · Light · Match Windows. Each is a mini window thumbnail (rail + page colours).
Updates		
Version + update status	Text	Status turns accent/bold when an update exists. No pop-ups, never forced.
Check for updates	Secondary button	Checks GitHub (also checked once at start).
Update now	Primary button	Only when an update exists; downloads and restarts. Not while live.
Hotkeys		
Reset to defaults	Subtle button	Restores defaults.
Use hotkeys, even while a game... is in front	Checkbox	Global hotkeys on/off.
Hotkey row (×16)	Label + capture box + ✕	Go live / End stream · Mute / unmute microphone · Cameras off / on · Be right back on / off · Start / stop recording · Next scene · Previous scene · Scene 1–9. Click the box, press keys; ✕ clears. Conflict shows a warning under the row.
Import from OBS LOCKED LIVE		
Find OBS settings	Primary button	Auto-detects OBS Studio settings.
Choose folder...	Secondary button	Portable OBS / exported profile.
Message	Status text	Result of the search.
Found items	Checkbox list	Each with title + detail (server/key, quality, capture, cameras, alerts, audio, recordings, network...).
Not imported (N)	Expander	What can't be brought over.
Import ticked settings	Primary button	Applies the ticked items.
Diagnostics		
FFmpeg in use	Mono text	Path/version.
Copy diagnostics · Open logs	Secondary buttons	Same actions as in the Activity card.
Privacy		
Privacy statement	Body text	No account, no cloud, no telemetry.

11. About page

Hero card	Logo + text	Logo 96 px, "Linkast" (26 px), version, one-line description.

Licence card	Card + pill	GPL-3.0-or-later pill, copyright, licence and warranty text, **Licence (GPL)** button.
Open-source components card	Card	Text about FFmpeg / RobustVideoMatting; buttons **Third-party notices** · **FFmpeg build and source** · **Source code** (open files/links).

12. Dialogs, menus and system pickers

All dialogs are standard Windows message boxes (not custom-styled).

Dialog	Type	When
"Show the new overlay"	Yes/No	A new overlay added while live needs a few-second stream restart.
"Switch scene"	Yes/No	A scene needs a restart (changes landscape ↔ vertical, or adds a camera not in the stream).
"Capture this display instead"	Yes/No, warning	Privacy confirmation before full-display capture.
"Linkast" unexpected error	OK, error	Crash guard; points to the log folder.
Add scene menu	Dropdown menu	From the + tile.
Scene tile menu	Context menu	Right-click a scene tile.
File pickers	Windows dialog	Overlay picture, scene background picture/video, camera background image.
Folder pickers	Windows dialog	Recordings folder, OBS settings folder.
Windows admin prompt (UAC)	System	Installing/removing Linkast Camera.

13. Stream states

State	Pill	Status title · what the user can do
Idle	OFFLINE (grey)	"Ready to stream" or "Not ready yet". Go live, Record available; all settings editable.
Preparing	PREPARING (amber)	"Getting ready…"
Connecting	CONNECTING (amber)	"Connecting…"
Live	● LIVE (red)	"Streaming normally". End stream shown; locked settings greyed out; header shows timer.
Reconnecting	RECONNECTING (amber)	"Reconnecting…" (automatic).
Stopping	STOPPING (amber)	"Ending stream…" (and end-scene countdown).
Failed	ERROR (red-orange)	"Stopped with an error"; error banner shown.
Recording only	—	"Record" button becomes "Stop recording".

14. Keyboard shortcuts

Ctrl+Enter	Go live (in the window)
Alt+S / W / T / B	Stream / Webcam / Settings / About pages

Ctrl+Alt+1…9	Switch to scene 1–9 (global, works in games)
Ctrl+Alt+← / →	Previous / next scene
Ctrl+Alt+B	Be right back
Configurable	Go live/End, mute mic, cameras off/on, record (Settings → Hotkeys)
Arrow keys	Nudge the selected item in the layout editor; move between options in segmented controls
Alt + drag	Trim (crop) in the preview / layout editor
Underlined letters	Many buttons and labels have Alt access keys (e.g. Go live, End stream, Refresh)

15. Icons in use (Segoe Fluent Icons)

All icons are glyphs from the Windows icon font; codes for reference.

Meaning	Code	Meaning	Code
Stream (nav)	`E93E`	Webcam (nav, studio tab, placeholder)	`E960`
Settings (nav)	`E713`	About (nav)	`E946`
Go live (play)	`E768`	End stream (stop)	`E71A`
Record (dot)	`E7C8`	Be right back (pause)	`E769`
Mute / mic	`E74F`	Silent in this scene	`E7F4`
Lock (local only, key, link hidden)	`E72E`	Refresh / reset	`E72C`
Add (+)	`E710`	Edit layout	`E70F`
Warning	`E7BA`	Error	`E783`
Open link / external	`E8A7`	Find best settings	`E9D9`
Copy	`E8C8`	Open folder	`E8B7`
Web overlay (globe)	`E774`	Show in preview (pin)	`E707`
Delete	`E74D`	Clear (⨉)	`E711`
Download / update / import	`E896`	Search (find OBS)	`E721`
Layout tab	`E740`	Choose image	`EB9F`
Test sound (speaker)	`E767`	Move left / right	`E76B` / `E76C`
Bring forward / Send back	`E74A` / `E74B`	Expand log (chevron)	`E70D`
Network: Wi-Fi / mobile / USB / VPN / Ethernet	`E701` / `EC05` / `E8EA` / `E705` / `E839`		

16. Notes for the redesign

Things we noticed while listing the UI. They are not decisions, just places to look.

- **Stream page is dense.** 7 tabs plus a status column. Some tabs (Scenes, Overlays) are scene editing; others (Destination, Network, Quality) are one-time setup. They could be split differently.
- **One control, two jobs.** The segmented control is used both as tabs and as value pickers (platform, shape, background mode), so it's hard to tell navigation from settings.
- **"Scene" vs "Layout".** The Webcam Studio Layout tab lists the same scenes as the Stream page strip but calls them layouts.
- **Duplicates.** Mic mute (Audio tab + status card); scene reorder/duplicate/delete (context menu + Scenes tab); silent-in-this-scene (mixer button + Scenes tab checkboxes); Copy diagnostics / Open logs (Activity card + Settings).
- **Live-locked controls** are only greyed out; there is no label saying why or what still works live.
- **Lots of long hint text** under controls; much of it explains interactions (drag, Alt-trim) that could be shown visually or once.
- **Checkboxes used as on/off switches** ("On", "Camera on", "Keep my face in frame"); a toggle switch might read better.
- **System message boxes** for confirmations do not match the app's look.
- **Hard-coded colours** outside the token system (preview backgrounds, placeholder text, theme thumbnails).
- **Fixed widths**: status column 300 px, inspector 360 px, layout side panel 290 px; at the 960 px minimum window width the main column gets tight.
- **Privacy matters visually**: the window is often captured on stream, so keys and alert links must stay hidden by default in any new design.